Retell: The Crazy Artist

Day 3 · Retell

What to do: Student A retells steps 1–4, student B steps 5–8. Then swap the roles.

In the book

4000 Essential English Words 1, Unit 12, **“The Crazy Artist”**, page 78 (the story) · page 79 (questions).
Read it once (5 minutes), close the book, then retell with the map below.

#	Say	Words to use
1	Who was Frenhofer? What was his life like?	artist · best · profit · neighbors · classes
2	What happened to his attitude?	stopped · new method · alone · apartment
3	How did he work?	day and night · rarely eating · thin
4	How long did he work on the painting?	many years · same painting · finally
5	Who did he invite?	professional · opinion · judge · compare · stairs
6	How did they feel before the painting?	excited · love it · surprised
7	What was in the painting?	no white · lines and colors · shapes · symbols
8	What did people think later?	terrible · beauty · articles · liked it

★ Ask and answer with might and if (add to your retelling)

1. What might the artists say if they like the painting? What might they say if they don’t? (opinion · judge)
2. If Frenhofer sells the painting, what might he do with the profit? (profit · apartment)
3. If you were a visitor, what would you do? Tell your partner. (symbols · quality)

Three ways to retell

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What to do: Rounds 1 to 3 take about 15 minutes. Then the speaking questions.

1 Round 1: with the story map

Retell the whole story to your partner. The listener ticks the words they hear.

- [ ] alone
- [ ] apartment
- [ ] article
- [ ] artist
- [ ] attitude
- [ ] compare
- [ ] judge
- [ ] magazine
- [ ] material
- [ ] meal
- [ ] method
- [ ] neighbor
- [ ] professional
- [ ] profit
- [ ] quality
- [ ] shape
- [ ] space
- [ ] stair
- [ ] symbol
- [ ] thin

2 Round 2: change the narrator

Retell it as **Frenhofer**, **one of the artists** or **the painting**. Use "I": *"I worked alone for many years, and I thought they might love it..."*

3 Round 3: change the ending

The artists love the painting at once. What happens next? Invent a new ending (3–4 sentences, use might and if).

4 Listener's check

- [ ] 5+ Unit 12 words
- [ ] might and if in the questions, past simple in the story
- [ ] a clear order
- [ ] one new idea

5 Warm-up: irregular verbs, the 3rd form, set 6 (say the 3rd form)

mean	spend	hide	lead
lend	light	shut	spread
stick	sweep		

meant · spent · hidden · led · lent · lit · shut · spread · stuck · swept